

KENNETH FLOREZ, CCNP, CCNA

LEAD / SENIOR NETWORK ENGINEER

Enterprise Networking | Wireless | SD-WAN | Network Automation | AI-Assisted Operations

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Lead / senior network engineering professional with 15+ years of experience designing, modernizing, and operating highly available enterprise infrastructure across healthcare, transportation, retail, and consulting environments. Deep Cisco experience across routing, switching, wireless, SD-WAN, and data center technologies, with experience supporting 600+ distributed locations. Strong background in BGP, OSPF, LAN/WAN, Cisco Catalyst 9800, Cisco ISE, resiliency, incident response, root cause analysis, infrastructure standards, and technical leadership. Uses automation and AI-assisted engineering workflows to accelerate troubleshooting, security-impact analysis, documentation, change planning, and operational decision-making.

TECHNICAL EXPERTISE

Routing & Switching: Cisco Catalyst, Cisco Nexus, IOS-XE, BGP, OSPF, STP, HSRP, VRFs, VLANs, QoS, IPv4/IPv6, NAT

Wireless & Access: Cisco Catalyst 9800, Cisco ISE, 802.1X, 802.11, Wi-Fi 6/6E, Meraki, RF optimization

WAN / SD-WAN: VMware VeloCloud SD-WAN, redundant ISP design, BGP, high availability, local breakout

Data Center: Cisco Nexus, OTV, DCI, vPC, HSRP, AWS Direct Connect, structured cabling, IDF/MDF standards

Observability: ThousandEyes, Cisco Catalyst Center / DNA Center, SolarWinds, ServiceNow, telemetry, root cause analysis

Automation & AI: Cisco Catalyst Center automation, REST APIs, Git, Python (developing), AI-assisted troubleshooting, analysis, documentation, security-impact review, and change planning

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Lead Network Engineer / Solutions Architect | Health Care | 2025-Present

- Architect and operate enterprise network infrastructure supporting 100+ healthcare facilities and thousands of clinicians.
- Lead Cisco Catalyst switching, routing, SD-WAN, wireless, and network modernization initiatives across a distributed healthcare environment.
- Deploy, operate, and optimize Cisco Catalyst 9800 wireless infrastructure, Cisco ISE/802.1X access, RF profiles, roaming, and high-availability services.
- Troubleshoot complex Layer 2/Layer 3, wireless, DHCP, DNS, and authentication issues and serve as a senior escalation resource for critical incidents.
- Design resilient network architectures using BGP, VRFs, NAT, redundant service providers, and high-availability technologies.
- Lead incident response and root cause analysis for outages and service degradation, improving troubleshooting consistency and MTTR through proactive monitoring and coordinated vendor/carrier escalation.
- Drive Cisco Catalyst Center / DNA Center automation, standardized deployment practices, MOPs, SOPs, change plans, and network standards to reduce manual effort and production risk.
- Monitor network health with ThousandEyes, Catalyst Center / DNA Center, and enterprise monitoring tools; partner with security teams on vulnerability remediation and security-impact analysis.
- Provide technical leadership and mentoring across engineering, infrastructure, security, field operations, vendors, carriers, and business stakeholders.

Senior Network Engineer | Transportation | 2019-2025

- Designed and operated mission-critical network infrastructure supporting 200+ facilities and three enterprise data centers.
- Engineered Cisco Nexus data center environments using OTV, DCI, vPC, HSRP, and high-availability architectures.
- Designed and supported resilient enterprise routing and switching for 24x7 transportation operations and served as a senior escalation engineer for complex Layer 2/Layer 3 incidents.
- Improved operational visibility through SolarWinds and standardized monitoring practices, enabling faster detection, diagnosis, and escalation.
- Developed implementation and change plans for infrastructure upgrades, migrations, capacity requirements, and reliability improvements while minimizing disruption.

Infrastructure Consultant (Part-Time, Weekends) | Airline | 2022-2024

- Delivered enterprise SD-WAN deployments, infrastructure refreshes, migrations, and standardized network implementation activities alongside full-time responsibilities.
- Worked with technical teams and stakeholders to execute network changes across large distributed enterprise environments.

Senior Network Engineer / Team Lead | Retail | 2006-2019

- Led and mentored a team of 10 network engineers supporting 300+ retail locations and distribution facilities.
- Designed enterprise LAN, WAN, wireless, and data center infrastructure and established engineering standards, governance, documentation, and change-management practices.
- Led large-scale infrastructure deployments, upgrades, and modernization initiatives; architected AWS Direct Connect connectivity through Equinix Ashburn.
- Established structured cabling and IDF/MDF infrastructure standards across 300+ locations, improving cable management, airflow, and network closet organization.

SELECTED ENTERPRISE ENGINEERING

Wireless Modernization: Catalyst 9800, Cisco ISE, 802.1X, Wi-Fi 6/6E, RF optimization, roaming, controller resiliency, and access-point operations.

SD-WAN & Resiliency: Distributed branch connectivity, redundant service providers, VMware VeloCloud, BGP, high availability, and local internet breakout.

Campus & Data Center: Cisco Catalyst and Nexus, 10G uplinks, OSPF, LACP/EtherChannel, vPC, HSRP, OTV/DCI, and production cutover planning.

Network Observability: ThousandEyes, Catalyst Center / DNA Center, SolarWinds, proactive monitoring, synthetic testing, incident response, and root-cause analysis.

Automation & AI: Standardized deployment workflows, REST APIs, Git, developing Python skills, and AI-assisted troubleshooting, documentation, MOP development, and security-impact assessment.

CERTIFICATIONS & EDUCATION

Certifications: Cisco Certified Network Professional (CCNP Enterprise) | Cisco Certified Network Associate (CCNA) | Zscaler Internet Access Administrator | F5 BIG-IP Administration

Education: University - Computer Science Coursework